soothing abdominal discomfort. Its tonic effect on the nervous system is less pronounced than that of lemon balm, but it nonetheless helps to lift the spirits and counter depression.
Related Species Yerba dulce (*L. dulcis*), native to Mexico, is used therapeutically as a demulcent and expectorant remedy. In Mexico, many other *Lippia* species are used for their antispasmodic, period-inducing, and stomach-soothing properties. *L. adoensis* is drunk as a tea in West Africa. See also lippia (*Lippia alba, preceding entry*).
Self-help Use Gas & bloating, p. 306.

Liquidambar orientalis (Hamamelidaceae)

Levant Storax

Description Deciduous tree growing to 20 ft (6 m). Has purplish-gray bark, lobed leaves, and small single yellow-white flowers.
Habitat & Cultivation Levant storax is found in southwestern Turkey. Storax balsam, a viscid gray-brown liquid, is extracted from the bark, which is pried off the tree in autumn.
Part Used Bark extract.

***Levant storax** is used to relieve congestive chest problems.*

Constituents Levant storax contains cinnamic acid, cinnamyl cinnamate, phenylpropyl cinnamate, triterpene acids, and a volatile oil.
History & Folklore Levant storax has been the *Liquidambar* species most commonly used medicinally since the 19th century. Levant storax is also employed as a fixative for perfumes.
Medicinal Actions & Uses Levant storax balsam acts as both an irritant and an expectorant within the respiratory tract, and it is one of the ingredients of Friar's Balsam, an expectorant mixture that is inhaled to stimulate a productive cough. In addition, levant storax balsam is applied externally to encourage the healing of skin diseases and problems such as scabies, wounds, and ulcers. Mixed with witch hazel (*Hamamelis virginiana*, p. 102) and rosewater (*Rosa species*), levant storax makes an astringent face lotion. In China, storax balsam is used to clear mucus congestion and to relieve pain and constriction in the chest.
Related Species American storax (*L. styraciflua*), which grows mainly in Honduras but is also found farther north, has been used since the time of the Maya for its healing properties.

Lobaria pulmonaria (Stictaceae)

Tree Lungwort

Description Gray or light green lichen with forked irregular lobes measuring up to ⅝ in (1.5 cm) across.
Habitat & Cultivation Found throughout Europe, tree lungwort grows on trees and rocks in woodland areas. It is gathered year round.
Part Used Lichen.
Constituents Tree lungwort contains a variety of plant acids (including stictic and sticinic acid), fatty acids, mucilage, and tannins.
History & Folklore Tree lungwort has been used since ancient times as a remedy for lung problems. The Italian physician and herbalist Pierandrea Matteoli (1501–77) recommended it for healing pulmonary ulcers and for treating blood-flecked phlegm. It was also used to treat wounds, heal ulcers, reduce excessive menstrual bleeding, relieve dysentery, and halt "choleric vomiting."
Medicinal Actions & Uses A beneficial but underused remedy, tree lungwort has expectorant and tonic properties. It aids in clearing congested mucus, reduces phlegm, and helps to increase the appetite. In a decoction sweetened with honey, it is appropriate for all conditions that are marked by chronic respiratory infections, especially coughs and bronchitis. The plant also treats asthma, pleurisy, and emphysema. Being astringent and demulcent, tree lungwort makes a useful treatment for pulmonary ulcers as well as for a variety of gastrointestinal problems. It is highly suitable for treating ailments in children.

Lomatium dissectum (Apiaceae)

Lomatium, Toza

Description Erect perennial, growing to 6½ ft (2 m), with a large woody taproot, divided, triangular leaves, and flowers in flat-topped umbels.
Habitat & Cultivation Native to coastal and inland regions of western North America from California as far north as British Columbia.
Parts Used Root.
Constituents Lomatium contains flavonoids, coumarins, tetronic acids, and volatile oil.
History & Folklore One of the most important medicinal plants of the Pacific Northwest, lomatium was "big medicine" for Native Americans and widely used for respiratory infections such as coughs, colds, and flu. In Nevada, lomatium root was combined with yarrow (*Achillea millefolium*, p. 56) to treat sexually transmitted diseases. In Oregon, a decoction of the root was applied to horses to rid them of ticks. During the 1917 influenza epidemic an American doctor, Ernest Krebbs, successfully used lomatium in his own practice, after noting the effective use of the herb by Native Americans.
Medicinal Actions & Uses Lomatium is today used mostly by botanical practitioners in North America to treat a broad range of viral infections, from chronic fatigue syndrome to influenza and herpes infections. A good tonic herb, it promotes peripheral blood flow and stimulates immune function. It is usually combined with other herbs such as echinacea (*Echinacea* spp., p. 92) or wild indigo root (*Baptisia tinctoria*, p. 176).
Research The tetronic acids have been shown to be markedly antimicrobial and toxic to fish (Native Americans used to place the fresh root in streams or pools in order to stun fish). Preliminary studies in Canada and the U.S. suggest that lomatium has significant antiviral activity.
Cautions A red measles-like rash, which clears on stopping treatment, may develop when taking lomatium. Like other members of the carrot family, lomatium can increase sensitivity to sunlight.

Lonicera spp. (Caprifoliaceae)

Honeysuckle, & Jin Yin Hua

Description A climber growing to 13 ft (4 m) that is deciduous (honeysuckle, *L. caprifolium*) or semi-evergreen (*jin yin hua*, *L. japonica*). Has paired oval leaves, yellow-orange (honeysuckle) or yellow-white (*jin yin hua*) tubular flowers, and red (honeysuckle) or black (*jin yin hua*) berries.
Habitat & Cultivation Honeysuckle is native to southern Europe and the Caucasus. *Jin yin hua* is native to China and Japan. Both plants are commonly found growing on walls, on trees, and in hedges. The flowers and leaves are gathered in summer just before the flowers open.
Parts Used Flowers, leaves, bark.
Constituents In Europe, *L. caprifolium* and *L. japonica* are often used interchangeably and